HRISHIKESH BELAGALI

Undergraduate Research Assistant

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SUMMARY

PhD applicant in ⟨⟩ with research interests in quantum computing for quantum chemistry, *ab-initio* and machine-learning molecular dynamics, fault-tolerant quantum compiling, and quantum error correction.

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Rust, C++, LaTeX

Packages: NumPy, PyTorch, JAX, scipy, Qiskit, Cirq, ruff, mypy, pytest

Softwares: LAMMPS, OVITO, NAMD, VMD

EDUCATION

Computer Science (B.S) — **Michigan State University Honors College**
2024-2027 (expected)
Current GPA: 4.0

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

Graduate Quantum Algorithms, Graduate Tensor Networks, Quantum Physics, Graduate Computational Foundations of Artificial Intelligence, Linear Algebra

EXPERIENCE

2026– **Undergraduate Research Assistant** — **MSU-Q**

- Developed fermionic backpropagation, an efficient classical method for simulating recent quantum experiments with up to 77 qubits and 3,500 two-qubit gates. Achieved a 70-fold runtime speedup (7s to 0.1s per energy evaluation on an NVIDIA GH200 node) through theoretical contributions and efficient GPU implementations.
- Implemented fermionic backpropagation in *ffsim*, a Python package for simulating fermionic quantum systems, extending the method's accessibility to the broader quantum chemistry research community.
- Built *propaq*, a Heisenberg propagation package achieving runtime competitive with state-of-the-art simulators while offering greater customizability, enabling circuit simulations in custom bases with support for custom noise and truncation policies.

2025–2026 **Honors Research Scholar** — **MSU Honors College/MSU-Q**

- Developed a gateset-rotation algorithm for identifying optimal unitary subgroups for quantum compilation, advised by Professor Ryan LaRose.
- Investigated the utility of gateset rotation for Hamiltonian pre-processing and improving the performance of anisotropic error correction codes.

2024– **Undergraduate Research Assistant** — **Vermaas Lab, Plant Research Laboratory**

- Simulated the effects of small molecules like butanol on *Clostridium acetobutylicum* and *Zymomonas mobilis* membrane dynamics.
- Parameterized cyclopropane fatty acids using CHARMM-GUI and validated the parameters against experimental data.
- Analyzed the effect of PDLP-5 (Plasmodesmata Located Protein) on water flow rates through PIP1;4 aquaporin tetramer using grid-steered molecular dynamics.

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

2026 *MSU CoE, MI* — **"Student View: Challenging the Quantum Advantage Boundary"** — **engineering.msu.edu**
Article highlighting my quantum computing research journey, published by the College of Engineering, Michigan State University.

PUBLICATIONS

[1] Hrishikesh Belagali, Ryan LaRose. "Propaq: A Python package for Heisenberg propagation", arXiv, 2026. manuscript submitted to *Quantum* (pending review). Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.07730.

[2] Hrishikesh Belagali, Thomas Van Camp, R. Pradeep, Sourin Das, Namit Anand, Ryan LaRose, "Efficient classical simulation of large-scale unitary cluster Jastrow circuits," *arXiv*, 2026, manuscript submitted to *Physical Review Letters* (pending review). Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2607.21337

[3] Hrishikesh Belagali, Nitin Kumar Singh, Josh V. Vermaas, "The Nanoscale Impact of Cyclopropane Fatty Acids and Hopanoids on Alcohol Tolerance in *Clostridium acetobutylicum* and *Zymomonas mobilis*," *ChemRxiv*, 2026, manuscript submitted to *ACS JPCB* (pending review). Available: https://chemrxiv.org/doi/full/10.26434/chemrxiv.15004463/v1

CONFERENCES

2026
ACS, IL

Molecular mechanisms of alcohol tolerance in Clostridium acetobutylicum and Zymomonas mobilis: The role of cyclopropane fatty acids and hopanoids **acs.digitellinc.com**
Poster presented at ACS Fall 2026 Conference

2026
MQC, IN

Efficient classical simulation of large-scale unitary cluster Jastrow circuits
Poster presented at MQC Entanglement 2026

2026
GLBRC, WI

The Nanoscale Impact of Cyclopropane Fatty Acids and Hopanoids on Alcohol Tolerance in *Clostridium acetobutylicum* and *Zymomonas mobilis*
Poster presented at Great Lakes Bioenergy Research Center Annual Science Meeting.

2026
MSU UURAF

Reducing T Gate Counts via Gateset Rotation
Poster presented at MSU Undergraduate Research and Arts Forum. Awarded first place in the Engineering, Computer Science and Mathematics division.

OPEN SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS

propaq
Python, Rust

propaq **github.com/pypi.org**
Primary developer of *propaq*, a Python package for Heisenberg propagation, designed for large-scale simulation on HPC clusters.
- Implemented thread-safe kernels and compact representation of Pauli and Majorana strings in Rust for optimal multi-threaded simulation.
- Developed a Python interface integrating *propaq* with Qiskit and Cirq for seamless simulation workflows using pyo3 bindings.
- Designed a plugin system for developing custom noise and truncation policies in Python, Rust, C, and Julia to enable user customization with minimal overhead.

ffsim
Python, Rust

ffsim **github.com**
Contributed to *ffsim*, a Python package for simulating fermionic quantum systems.
- Implemented fermionic backpropagation, from "Efficient classical simulation of large-scale unitary cluster Jastrow circuits" (arXiv:2607.21337) into *ffsim* for fast unitary cluster Jastrow ansatz simulation.
- Created a JAX-based implementation for GPU-accelerated variational optimization.

QuTiP
Python

Quantum Toolbox in Python (QuTiP) **github.com**
Contributed to QuTiP, an open-source software for simulating quantum systems.
- Implemented functionality to return eigenkets as an operator in the Qobj class.

Python
NumPy

aqua-blue **github.com/pypi.org**
Secondary maintainer of aqua-blue, a package building echo state networks.
- Implemented reservoir state time-lag, sparsity and spectral radius to improve prediction accuracy.
- Introduced timezone-aware datetime support for seamless interfacing with data pipelines.
- Demonstrated prediction capability by predicting quantum time evolution of Gaussian wave packets.

tce-lib
Python

tce-lib **github.com**
Contributed to tce-lib, a Python package for building tensor cluster expansion models for concentrated alloys.
- Implemented lazy evaluation of Monte Carlo trajectories for efficient simulation on HPC clusters.

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Wielenga Research Scholarship, Honors College (2025-2026)
- Dean's List (Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026)
- Senator Joe and Mary Conroy Endowed Scholarship, College of Engineering (2024)

PROJECTS

Python
Qiskit

Adiabatic Quantum Computation **github.com**
Implemented a quantum adiabatic algorithm to solve QUBO type problems using the Trotter-Suzuki approximation and quantum Ising model formulation techniques.

Python
OVITO
pyMOL

Genetic Annealing to Determine Protein Structures **github.com**
Monte Carlo Genetic Algorithm to determine protein structures through the optimization of Irbäck's off-lattice model energy equation (RMSD < 3.0).